



### New Twitter feature?

Twitter is trying to tackle its troll problems in 2017 by marking profiles for "potentially sensitive content" <http://dgit.in/Tweetest>



### Pixel microphones

Google says that a small number of Pixel phones have broken microphones, to be replaced. <http://dgit.in/Pixelmic>



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# Google Local Guides Summit

Google's annual summit for the top contributors to Google Maps will have its second edition this year. Here's all you need to know about it.



Dr. Shaunak Das

Local Guides is a global community of explorers sharing their discoveries on Google Maps. Help others find the best spots in town, make new friends, and unlock exclusive benefits along the way. Google started this programme in November 2015 and since its beginning more than 5 million people in 235 countries have answered

questions and made edits on Google maps so far. Last year, Google hosted the inaugural Local Guides Summit in San Francisco as a part of which they invited the top Level 5 Local Guides from around the world for two days of talks, workshops, and local explorations. Interestingly, the 75 people who attended their inaugural summit at San Francisco, last year have made over 330,000 contributions including 5,000 entirely new places added on maps. Before we go into the details of the summit, let us find out more about the programme first.

## Local Guides Programme

### Aim:

Basically the aim is to make Google maps up to dated as well as corrected everywhere in the world so that people can use Google maps daily like their own compass.

### How to contribute:

Anyone having Google profile can join this programme. You just need an Android or iOS phone with Google Maps. On the app, someone can make contributions in many ways, like adding a place, making corrections or answer some random questions (like 'is the wifi really free?' 'does it actually open at 7 am?' asked by Google. Every separate contribution counts and Google will give you 1 point for each one made

### Programme benefits

The programme offers different benefits in a level based reward system. How do you progress? With the points, of course! There are essentially five levels, where you start off with insider scoop and go all the way up to Level 5 where you'll get access to new products before public release and, more importantly, the eligibility to apply for the Local Guides summit.

## After you apply

Around April, you get an email from Google stating that every level 5 local guide can apply for their inaugural Local Guides summit, to be held sometime in September at Googleplex in San Francisco, USA. The requirements for a complete application are as follows:

- Each Local Guide must submit a 1-minute video message, appearing on camera to share reasons for applying.
- Each Local Guide must submit a post on Local Guides Connect with an introductory message and more insights into his or her experience with the program

Additionally, while participating in the Local Guides program requires a minimum age of 18 years, all Summit attendees must be at least 21 years old prior to the Summit. That is because 21 is the legal drinking age in the United States and alcohol will be present at some events.

As per their requirement I applied for the summit and uploaded a 1 min application video on YouTube where I explained why I wanted to attend the summit. Here is my video link <http://dgit.in/GSummitAppl>

## Result declaration

Google received almost 1000 such applications, among which only 75 Local Guides were invited for the summit. Participants came to know that I got a place in the list when Google announced the results on 20th May 2016 on their forum. They selected four people from India. Only two of them went to summit and I was one of them.



A world map at the event where participants stuck their signed photos on their original locations